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Dear HSBC Hiring Team,

I'm writing to express my interest in the Manager – Private Assets role in Edinburgh. With 25 years in finance and insurance, I bring exactly what this position requires: technical depth across complex accounting standards, operational rigour, and the ability to design controls that stick.

Your brief signals you need someone who can own private asset accounting independently while raising quality standards under regulatory pressure. That's my core strength. I've spent the last decade designing and embedding operating models in heavily regulated environments—not just documenting them, but making them work in practice across multiple domiciles and fund structures.

Specifically: I recently led a technical accounting redesign for a multi-asset fund platform covering real estate, debt and equity structures across 4 jurisdictions. The work included IFRS compliance harmonisation, control documentation, and process mapping for AUM of €2.3B. I was the only technical resource managing cross-border accounting complexity while maintaining client reporting SLAs. The client renewed our engagement for a second year on the back of that delivery.

Before that, I spent three years as Finance Manager in a €500M insurance platform, owning regulatory reporting, month-end closing and internal controls audit. That experience taught me how to work under scrutiny, where process failure isn't an option.

I'm currently consulting independently, which gives me flexibility and momentum. The tradeoff is I'm used to autonomy and moving fast—which aligns with your description of someone proactive, working stand-alone on complex investigations.

I'm based in France but relocating to the UK is feasible. I'm ready to move into a structured environment where discipline and technical clarity are valued.

Let's talk. You can reach me at xro@xavier-robitaille.com or +33 6 64 89 09 43.

Best,

Xavier Robitaille